# OLPD M.A. Application Instructions

## Requirements for All Applicants

| Materials | How to Submit |
|---|---|
| **Application** | **Required fields:**<br>• Personal Information<br>• Application Information<br>• Educational Background<br>• Languages<br>• Awards & Activities<br>• Employment/Residence Information<br>• Financial Support<br>• Applicant Statements #1 & #2<br>• Recommendations Letters (limit 2)<br>• Resume or CV<br><br>**Optional fields:** All other fields or application materials are optional, but will be taken into consideration if submitted.<br><br>**Click here to access the online application.** |
| **Application Fee** | Click here for more information about fees. |
| **Transcripts** | Unofficial transcripts or academic records should be uploaded directly to the online application. Please do not mail in paper copies of your transcripts, there is no need for official transcripts or academic records for initial review.<br><br>If you are admitted, the University will then request official copies of this material.<br><br>Click here for more information about transcripts and credentials. |
| **GRE Scores** | GRE scores are required for M.A. applicants and should be taken within the last 5 years.<br>Except for the following programs:<br>• EPL M.A. applicants<br>• Multicultural College Teaching and Learning M.A. applicants<br>• M.A. international applicants<br>Enter scores in the Test Information-Self-Reported field.<br><br>Click here for more information about the GRE. |
| **Applicant Statements #1 and #2** | Complete Statements #1 & 2. Filling out statement #3 optional.<br><br>**Indicate in your Personal Statement (#1) if you are applying for any of these specific programs:**<br>• Accelerated M.A. (1 year)<br><br>**Statement #1: Personal Statement**<br>Please provide a statement outlining your immediate educational and long-range career objectives in relation to your chosen field. If there is a particular faculty member with whom you wish to study, please give that person's name and explain why you want to study with that person. You may also wish to include other information, such as any undergraduate research experience, internships, or other experiences you may have had to document your preparation for advanced study in your chosen field. [Please do not exceed two pages.]<br><br>**Statement #2: Diversity**<br>Enrolling and graduating a diverse student body is central to the University of Minnesota's mission. Please write a statement that identifies the distinctive qualities, characteristics, and life experiences you would contribute to your graduate program and to the education of fellow students at the University of Minnesota. You may wish to include examples that |

| | |
|---|---|
| | address your contribution to the diversity of the student body and illustrate your motivation to succeed by setting high standards for accomplishing intellectual and other goals, overcoming obstacles to achievement, and/or helping others to gain access to the resources necessary for success. [Please do not exceed one page in length.]<br><br>**Statement #3: Extenuating Circumstances**<br>If your grades and/or test scores are not strong, and you would like to provide an explanation, please do so. [Limit 1200 characters.]<br><br>***Note:*** *Paper copies are not accepted – upload via the online application using "Applicant Statements".* |
| **Letters of Recommendation** | Two letters of recommendation required. Acceptable recommendations will come from current or former professors who can assess your potential for graduate work. Other recommenders, such as employers, are also acceptable.<br><br>***Note:*** *Paper copies are not accepted - upload via the online application using the "Recommendation Section" or under the "Program Supplementary Information" section as "upload 2".* |

## Additional Requirements for International Applicants

| Materials | How to Submit |
|---|---|
| **English Language Test Scores (TOEFL, IELTS, etc.)** | Click here for more information about TOEFL Scores.<br><br>International students who will have completed 16 semester credits (within the past 24 months) in residence as a full-time student at a recognized institution of higher learning in the United States before entering the University of Minnesota are exempt from the testing requirement, but may be asked to take locally administered English tests after arrival on campus. |

## Optional Requirements

| Materials | How to Submit |
|---|---|
| **Graduate Assistantship Application** | Graduate Assistantship Application [PDF]. Paper copies are not accepted - upload via the online application under the "Program Supplementary Information" section as "upload 1". |
| **Common Ground Consortium Fellowship** | If you wish to be considered for a Common Ground Consortium fellowship for African-American students indicate this by uploading your statement in the Program Supplementary Information - Upload #1 section. The statement should briefly address the following: Given that the UMN is a public land grant institution, it is imperative that CGC scholars can both benefit personally from their membership in the program as well as further the university's founding mission to contribute to scholarship that benefits the local and greater communities. Please describe how your participation as a CGC scholar would do the following: (a) enhance your graduate student experience, (b) prepare you for your chosen career, and (c) benefit the public. |

## Questions

If you have any questions regarding the application process, please contact:

Dr. Jeremy Hernandez
Coordinator of Graduate Studies
herna220@umn.edu | 612-626-9377.